

GitHub: Pull Requests & Code Review

Grade 6 | Session 2

In our last session, we learned how Git acts like a time machine. But what happens when you're working with a team? How do you make sure everyone's changes fit together perfectly? Today, we're exploring the power of teamwork through Pull Requests and Code Reviews.

Teamwork Insight: A great Pull Request is small and focused. It's much easier for your friends to review one specific feature than a giant pile of changes!

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Why Teamwork Matters

Recap: When things go wrong

Imagine a big school project where everyone writes their own part, but no one checks the final report before handing it in. You might find spelling mistakes, or even worse, two people might have written about the same thing! Working together means catching mistakes early and helping each other improve.

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What is a Pull Request?

The Panchayat Proposal

A Pull Request (or PR) is like a formal proposal. Think of it like asking your school committee or a 'Panchayat' to approve a new rule before it becomes final. You're saying: 'Hey team, I've made these changes. Can you check them before I add them to our main project?'

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Real World Example: Gully Cricket App

The 'Super Over' Feature

Imagine you're building a Gully Cricket scoring app with your friends. You want to add a new 'Super Over' feature. Instead of just adding it and potentially breaking the app, you create a Pull Request. This lets your team review your code and make sure it works for everyone.

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The Reviewer's Eyes

Checklist for Success

When you're asked to review a teammate's code, you should look for three main things: 1. Clarity: Is the change easy to understand? 2. Correctness: Does it actually fix the problem? 3. Kindness: Are you providing your feedback in a way that helps your friend grow?

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Activity: The Peer Review Circle

Learning by Doing

Let's try a non-coding review! Write down the steps to make a perfect cup of Masala Chai. Now, swap your paper with a partner. Your job is to review their steps. Did they forget the ginger? Is the boiling time clear? Remember to be specific and helpful!

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Good vs. Bad Review Comments

Communication is Key

A bad comment is 'This is wrong.' It doesn't help anyone improve. A good comment is 'I noticed this might cause an issue, what do you think about adding a check here?' One is a dead end; the other is a conversation that leads to better code.

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The Rule of Kindness

Review the Code, Not the Coder

This is the most important rule: focus on helping improve the work, not criticizing the person who wrote it. We all make mistakes! Use polite language and offer solutions instead of just pointing out problems. Kindness makes teamwork fun and productive.

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The Reviewer's Script

Helpful Phrases to Use

Sometimes it's hard to find the right words. Try using these 'scripts': 'I noticed that...', 'Could we try...', or 'What do you think about...?' These phrases open up a discussion gently and show that you appreciate your teammate's hard work.

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The Final Merge

Bringing it All Together

Once the review is finished and all changes are approved, it's time for the 'Merge'. This is the digital handshake where your new feature finally becomes part of the main project. Because of the PR and review, you can be confident your code is the best it can be!

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Session 2 Summary

Teamwork Champions

Today we learned that Pull Requests are proposals for change, Code Reviews are safety checks by our peers, and Kindness is the secret ingredient for great software. You are now ready to collaborate like professional developers!

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